ONLINE STORE · VEHICLE WORKFLOW GUIDE

Part 2

Site map and content: every page and what goes on it

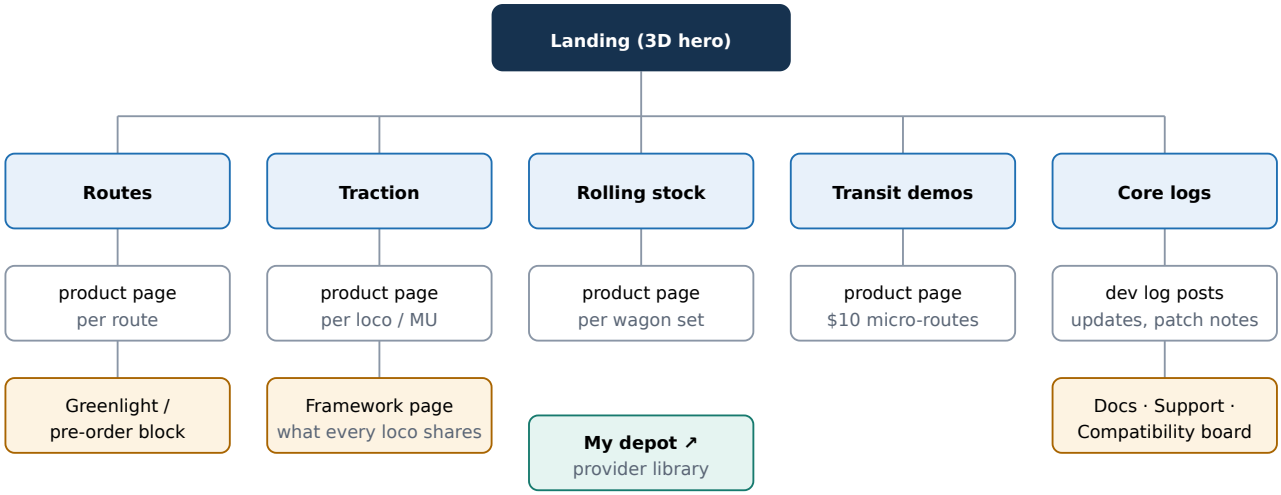
The pages, the words, the product-page anatomy, the legal footnote, demo tiers and pre-order blocks. Written so you can fill a template rather than face a blank page.

In this part

1. Site map
2. The landing page, block by block
3. Anatomy of a product page
4. Writing the copy: a formula
5. Naming products safely
6. Demos, proving grounds and pre-orders
7. Dev log, docs and support
8. Images and video to prepare
9. Content checklist per product

Layout, navigation, the technical spec grid, the copy example and the community-first footnote follow the opportunity analysis (“What exactly would my 3rd party store website look like?”). Naming guidance follows its copyright sections; it is not legal advice.

1 · Site map



Menu order from the analysis: ROUTES · TRACK TRACTION · ROLLING STOCK · TRANSIT DEMOS · CORE LOGS, plus the account link.

Figure 2.1 · The site map. Five menu items keep a growing catalogue readable; every leaf is a product page built from the same template.

2 · The landing page, block by block

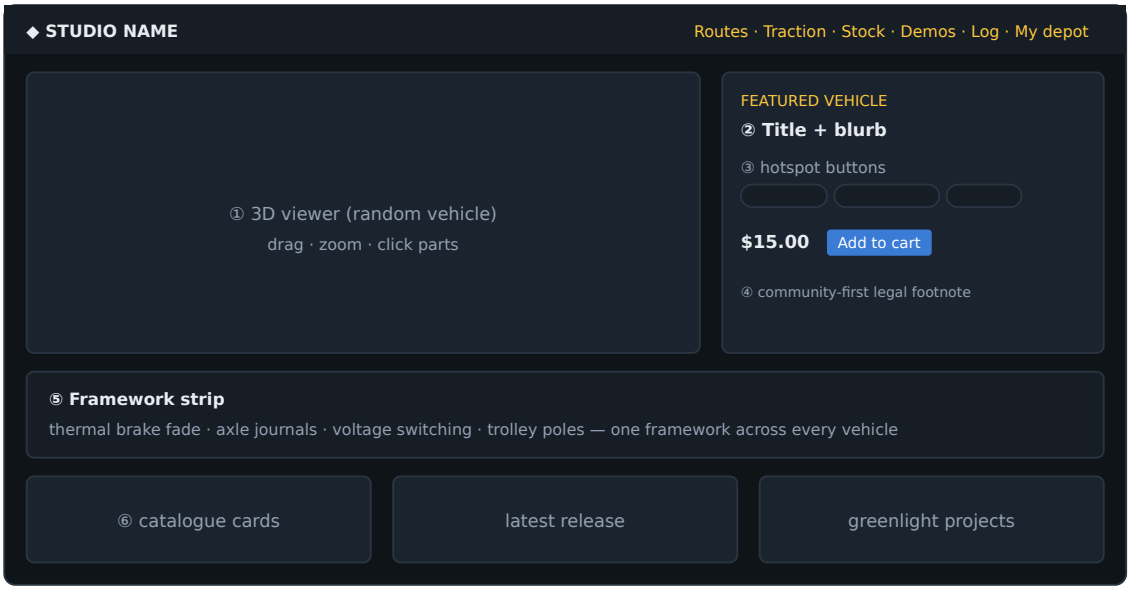


Figure 2.2 · Landing page blocks (the demo site implements ①–④ and ⑥ demo). ① proves the craft; ② names it; ③ lets the visitor *operate* it; ④ reassures community painters; ⑤ sells the thing every product shares; ⑥ routes into the catalogue.

3 · Anatomy of a product page

Block	Content	Source
Header	Title using the design name · price · Add to cart (links to the provider) · “Interactive preview” viewer with the product's own hotspots	Analysis “Product Header”; Part 4 viewer
Technical spec grid	Subsystem · Deployment state · Core mechanics engaged. Rows such as Propulsion profile / Thermal degradation / Lubrication tracking / Audio environment	Analysis “The Technical Spec Grid”
Copy	Three paragraphs: the machine, the challenge, the framework (see §4)	Analysis “Selling the Challenge”
Media	6–10 screenshots, one 20–30 s silent loop, optional cab tour video	§8
Requirements	Game and version, DLC dependencies, disk space, framework version	Your installer
Installation	Steps for the installer; where files land; how to verify	Part 6
Version and changelog	Current version, date, last three changes, link to the dev log	Part 6
Community-first footnote	The standard disclaimer (§5)	Analysis
Related	“Runs on” routes, “Pairs with” wagons, the $9 impulse add-on	Analysis cross-sell logic

4 · Writing the copy: a formula

Paragraph 1 · The machine (what it is, in design terms)

“Take command of the 500-horsepower Class EF-4 ‘Mountain Titan’. Built to conquer unrelenting mountain gradients…” Lead with the class, nickname and the one number railfans quote. No corporate names.

Paragraph 2 · The challenge (what the player must manage)

“…operators must look past basic throttle handling and actively monitor circuit overvoltage, exponential self-ventilation cooling curves, and cumulative thermal brake fade. Run too fast, and face a permanent, Pro-Mode axle hotbox seizure.” Name three mechanics and one consequence.

Paragraph 3 · The framework (why buying one makes the next better)

“Full compatibility with the Advanced Simulation Framework: inspection report (Shift+I), maintenance loop (Shift+O), open texture directories.” Link to the Framework page.

Keep each paragraph under 60 words. The spec grid carries the detail; the copy carries the feeling.

5 · Naming products safely

Roadmap name	Storefront title	Why
PRR steam turbine S2	Class S2 Steam Turbine Locomotive	Mechanical class, no railroad mark
Milwaukee Road Little Joe	Class EF-4 “Little Joe” Electric	Class + folk nickname
NYC S-motor	Class S-Motor Historic Electric	Internal classification
DART Kinki Sharyo SLRV	Modern 3-Section Articulated LRV / Texas Urban Light Rail Vehicle	Drops manufacturer and agency marks
Union Pacific M-10000	Model M-10000 Early Streamliner	Avoid active OEM/railroad names
Texas Electric Railway route	Texas Electric Railway: Plano Proving Ground Edition	Defunct 75+ years; lower risk per the analysis

Ship liveries without logos and leave texture folders open; add this footnote to every product page (from the analysis):

```
NOTICE: This product is an independent artistic recreation modeled strictly after mechanical
builder
specifications and engineering documentation. It features no official corporate affiliation or
endorsement. UV maps and texture directories are left completely open to support user-generated
customization and community-distributed visual paint schemes.
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The analysis is explicit that this is not legal advice and recommends an IP lawyer's review before launch. So is this guide.

6 · Demos, proving grounds and pre-orders

Demo tiers (“short and deep”)

- Never call it a demo on the page: “Plano Proving Ground Edition”, “Mechanics Preview Pack”.
- 5–10 miles or one vehicle, with the **full** framework intact. Price $0–12.
- Its product page carries the same viewer and spec grid as a $40 product, so buyers see the standard.

Greenlight block (pre-orders)

- Interactive model + spec sheet + a funding bar: “$2,100 of $7,000”.
- Tiers from the analysis: ≈ $1,500 proving ground → ≈ $3,500 fleet expansion → ≈ $7,000 full route. Ask for 20–30% more than you need to cover fees.
- Pre-orders live on the provider (most support them); the bar on your site is a number you update.
- Backers get a “Founders” skin or early access; say so on the block.

7 · Dev log, docs and support

- **Dev log:** one post per milestone with a viewer embed of the WIP model, three screenshots and the next milestone. Doubles as the crowdfunding progress feed.

- **Docs:** one page per product: controls, hotkeys (Shift+I, Shift+O…), known issues, FAQ. Plus the **Framework page** describing the shared mechanics once.
- **Compatibility board:** a table: product · version · framework version · game version tested. Updated with each release (Part 6).
- **Support:** an email address and a public thread or Discord. State response times you can keep.

8 · Images and video to prepare

Asset	Spec	Where
Hero loop	20–30 s, 1920×1080, silent, no UI, ≤ 8 MB (H.264/WebM), shows motion: sparks, smoke, pole raise	Landing background / product media
Product screenshots	6–10 at 1920×1080, same time of day, no HUD; one cab, one exterior ¾, one detail, one night	Product page and provider listing
Card thumbnail	800×500, ¾ exterior on plain background	Catalogue cards
Web model (.glb)	≤ 60 k triangles, ≤ 8 MB, 2048 px textures max (Part 3)	Viewer
Logo and favicon	SVG + 512 px PNG	Site header, provider store
Cab tour video (optional)	2–3 min, narrated	Product page, YouTube

9 · Content checklist per product

✓	Item
☐	Design-name title, price, one-line summary
☐	Web GLB + manifest with 3–8 hotspots (Part 3)
☐	Spec grid rows filled; three copy paragraphs
☐	Screenshots, thumbnail, hero loop
☐	Requirements, installation, version/changelog
☐	Community-first footnote present
☐	Provider product created with the same title/images; “Buy” link pasted into the page
☐	Docs page and Compatibility board row